

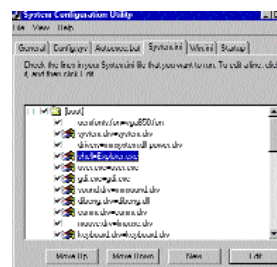
Plagued by a virus

Q. I use the Internet frequently and have McAfee anti-virus installed on my PC. I think my machine is infected with some virus. Whenever I connect to the Net, approximately 800 files of 78 KB with the .eml extension get created in each folder with a zero-byte attachment (ATT00004.txt). The Internet is shared by six other PCs and they all seem to be infected.

Vikram Bhatia

Via e-mail

A. Your PCs seem to be infected by the Nimda virus. To remove it, update your anti-virus software from www.nai.com. You can also find a McAfee anti-virus update on the Mindware CD under **Software > Essentials**. If



Use msconfig to edit your system.ini file

this does not help, you'll have to remove it manually. First, disconnect the machine from the network, disable all network shares and turn off all file sharing. Now delete all

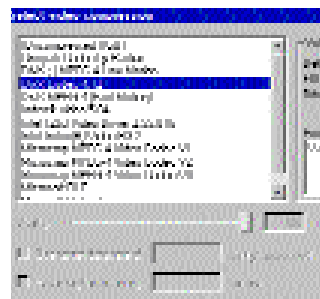


.eml and .nws files of 78 or 79 KB size, dated later than September 18, 2001. You can use Windows Find to locate all files with these extensions. Delete all instances of readme.exe and load.exe. If you are running Windows 2000 or XP, delete any instances of mmc.exe, admin.dll and riched20.dll dated September 18, 2001 or later, sized 58 or 59 KB. You may have to reinstall or repair Windows or Office after doing so.

If you are running Windows 98, run msconfig and expand [boot] under the System.ini tab. You will find a line that reads **shell=explorer.exe**. If there is anything else on the line, change it to **shell=explorer.exe**

After rebooting the machine you can restore the network and enable file sharing.

to encode files with the DivX codec. This software can take most video formats (including MPEG 1 and MPEG 1.2 DAT files) for input and any installed codec for encoding. (For a step-by-step procedure, check the digital video workshop on page 96.) For more information, check www.mydivx.com.



Select the DivX codec in VirtualDub

New graphics card

Q. I have a PC with a Pentium III 600 MHz processor and 128 MB RAM at 133 MHz. I just installed a

CD-RW drive and an nVidia graphics card. I set the CD-RW drive to master and the CD-ROM drive to slave on the same channel. When I restarted the computer, it showed me an error that read 'C:\>C:\ESSAUDIO-BLASTER Primary Codec Error'. I removed the CD-RW drive, but I still get the error. The CD-ROM drive is still kept as slave. I cannot play audio and video files. How do I solve the problem?

Deepak

Via e-mail

A. The CD-RW and CD-ROM drives don't have anything to do with this problem. The graphics card is probably the culprit. However, it could just as easily be due to the soundcard's drivers. Your system seems to be loading the drivers in DOS, though this is not required. Open

c:\autoexec.bat in Notepad and add **REM** before all the lines that refer to ESSAudio. For example, if the line reads **C:\ESSAUDIO.COM**, change it to **REM C:\ESSAUDIO.COM**. If the soundcard does not work in Windows, then you will have to download the latest version of its drivers and install them from <http://www.esstech.com/tech-supply/drivers.shtm>.

If the problem still persists, then the soundcard is probably conflicting with the graphics card. Try downloading the latest nVidia Detonator drivers for the graphics card from www.nvidia.com. If this does not help either, change the soundcard slot if it is not an onboard card. You can also check the AGP aperture size set in the BIOS. Set it to twice the amount of RAM you have, i.e., 256 MB.

Dirty Recycle Bin

Q. On Windows 98, whenever I try to empty the Recycle Bin, I get the following message: 'The Recycle Bin format is invalid. Do you want to empty the Recycle Bin?' If I click Yes, the system hangs, and if I click on No, nothing happens. However, I can delete files from DOS. Please give me a solution.

Shyam

Via e-mail

A. Windows 98 emulates a Recycle Bin from a folder named Recycled—one folder for every drive. One or all of these folders is probably corrupted on your system. Start the PC in DOS mode by holding down the [Ctrl] key while the PC is booting to bring up the Windows 98 Startup menu and choose Command Prompt Only. At the command prompt, type **attrib -s -h recycled** to remove the system and hidden attributes of the folder.

Unless this is done, DOS will not allow you to delete the folder. Then type **deltree /y recycled** to delete the folder. Repeat this for every drive. Note that all items in the Recycle Bin will be deleted. Now, restart to Windows and run a thorough Scandisk on all drives to check for errors. The folders will be recreated by Windows as required.

Office XP SP1

Q. I have Windows 98 SE and Office XP installed on my PC. I recently tried to update Office XP with Service Pack 1 (SP1) from the February Digit CD. During installation, I got an error message that reads: 'Error 1328: Error applying patch to file. C:\Config.msi\PTA0A0.TMP. It has probably been updated by other means and can no longer be modified by this patch.' What can be wrong?

Nishant Sangar

Via e-mail